Mount Pleasant Fire Department
After Action Report

OCA: 25-0016238	**DATE:** 2/22/2025	**Distribution:**
ISSUED BY: Captain Shane Himes, Engine Company 501		
INCIDENT: Structure Fire, 3012 Jasper Blvd, Sullivan's Island		

Members present for Critique: DC Harshaw (IOPFD), BC Chamberlin, BC Giddens (IOPFD), BC Jacumin, BC Poole, Captain Carpenter, Captain Dahlman, Captain A. Dennis, Captain Himes, Captain Lord (IOPFD), Engineer D. Brown, Engineer Gibbons, Engineer Hogan (IOPFD), Engineer Rousse (IOPFD), Engineer Stringer, DOII Connelly, DOII Cummings, DOI Kelly, Firefighter Comer (IOPFD), Firefighter Crisp, Firefighter Durish, Firefighter Evans, Firefighter McNeil, Firefighter Rodrigez (IOPFD), Firefighter Sonnefeld, and Firefighter N. Wollenbecker.

Overview of incident: E501 and BC508 were dispatched to a building fire on Sullivan's Island. While en route, E501 requested an additional 3 engines and 1 ladder. See unit specific assignments. Upon extinguishment, the scene was turned back over to SIFD. Companies then returned to service.

Weather: At 1800, Partly Cloudy, Temperature: 52°F, Winds: 7 mph SE, Humidity: 57%, Precipitation: 0%

Resources On Scene:

Unit	Agency	Initial Assignment
E1201	SIFD	1st Engine
E501	MPFD	2nd Engine
TW1002	IOPFD	1st Aerial
C1201	SIFD	1st Chief, Incident Command
BC508	MPFD	2nd Chief, Safety
BC1006	IOPFD	3rd Chief, Alpha Side Supervisor
E502	MPFD	3rd Engine
E503	MPFD	4th Engine
RS504	MPFD	1st Rescue
L503	MPFD	2nd Aerial
E505	MPFD	5th Engine
E116	CFD	6th Engine

Incident Review
Initial Actions:

Arrival	Unit	Assignment	Duties (Offensive)	Duties (Defensive)
18:10:07	E1201	1st Engine	300' 1.75" (Yellow), Charlie (EXT)	1.75", Delta (EXT)
18:10:08	E501	1st/2nd Engine	Initiated Command, 300' 1.75" (Red), Alpha (DIV1), Established Water Supply (Jasper/30)	2.5", Alpha (EXT), Overhaul 1.75" (White) Alpha (DIV2ROOF)
18:11:05	TW1002	1st Aerial	Split Crew, Search, Alpha (DIV1), Deployed 1.75" (Blue)	Elevated Master Stream Alpha/Delta
18:13:12	C1201	1st Chief	Incident Command, Charlie	Incident Command
18:14:45	BC508	2nd Chief	Safety, Charlie	Safety/Interior
18:15:20	BC1006	3rd Chief	Alpha	Alpha
18:19:32	E503	4th Engine	300' 1.75" (Yellow) Charlie (DIV2/EXT)	
18:20:37	E502	3rd Engine	Initated RIT, Alpha, 250' 1.75" (Blue), Alpha (DIV2/3)	250' 1.75", (Blue) Alpha (DIV2/3)
18:21:56	RS504	1st Rescue	Split, Overhaul, Alpha (DIV1/3)	1.75" (Red), Bravo (EXT) Split, Overhaul, Alpha (DIV2/3)
18:24:43	L503	2nd Aerial	Assisted E503 with 300' 1.75" (Yellow) Charlie (DIV2/EXT)	Assisted E501 with 1.75" (White)
18:41:48	E505	5th Engine		Assisted Water Supply to TW1002, 1.75", Charlie (EXT), Overhaul (DIV1/2)
18:54:03	E116	6th Engine		2.5", Alpha (EXT), Overhaul (DIV2)

Discussion/Open Forum

What was our mission?:

- To aid SIFD with a safe, effective, and adequate structure fire response.
- **Had we planned for this event?**
  - Yes, see Attachment A.
- **Were there any gaps in our planning?**
  - Yes
    - E1201 was not adequately staffed as 2/4 of the firefighters were not qualified.
    - An additional 3 Engines and 1 Ladder was requested by E501.
      - The requester must request specific units, the CAD recommended and dispatched incorrect units, which had to be corrected on the back end.
      - RS504 replaced the dispatched E505.
        - RS504 is not on the initial upgrade package and should be.
        - When E505 was dropped off the response initially, this left only 3 responding engines (not including E1201), therefore no company to take 3rd Engine duties when E502 was reassigned to 2nd Engine, as E503 was already committed to 4th Engine duties. BC508 requested the next unit to take RIT, however no engine arrived following to take RIT duties.
        - RS504 assumed 1st Rescue duties and actions by the crew were a crucial aid to fighting this fire.
    - An additional BC was requested to be added to future responses, so that BC's could establish Operations, Accountability, and Safety, whereas SIFD automatically takes Incident Command.

What went well?/PROS:

- **Did we have the resources for conducting this event?**
  - Requested, for future responses, to:
    - Add an Additional Battalion Chief so that BC's could establish Operations, Accountability, and Safety, whereas SIFD automatically takes Incident Command.
    - Add RS504 to ensure adequate completion of ladder company duties and overall safety of personnel.
    - Ensure 4 engines (not including SIFD) are responding to ensure all four initial engine operations are established and adequately performed. RS504 replaced an engine and did not serve in an engine role. This addition of RS504 shouldn't replace an engine company, thus mimicking the Auto-Aid agreement response.

- **Did we do all we could to make this a successful operation?**
    - Yes
        - E501 arrived and performed the role of the 1st Engine (2nd to E1201), initially established command, made a significant push, and knocked down the 1st Division/bulk of initial fire. E501A established a water supply that was later double tapped and ultimately pumped four handlines and a tower ladder in defensive operations.
        - BC508 and BC1006 established Safety on the Charlie side and supervised the Alpha side. This alternative command structure worked to serve as liaisons to C1201 (Incident Command) and to ensure the safety and proper utilization of mutual aid resources.
        - E502 arrived 3rd Engine (3rd to E1201) initially establishing RIT and quickly being reassigned to 2nd Engine responsibilities. E502 advanced 1.75" to both 2nd and 3rd Divisions. E502 knocked down fire on the 2nd Division, made the 3rd Division, but was called out of the structure due to rapidly decreasing conditions observed by Safety.
        - RS504 arrived as 1st Rescue and split crews to fill in gaps in searching for life/fire and overhauling, thus aiding E502 in their attempt to find hidden fire and stop the advancement of fire.

What could have gone better?/CONS:

- The initial establishment of command and later assumption of command was confusing and conflicting. This ultimately led to deployment/assistance with handlines by ladder companies and lack of completed primary and secondary searches.
- Announcement of arrival order/duty by Automatic Aid Group Partners would lead to less confusion, competition for radio traffic, and ensure critical tasks are completed in order of predetermined priority.
- **Did we see any unsafe behaviors?**
    - Yes, C1201 arrived, and with disregard, took command without proper relinquishment of command. This led to confusion and conflicting fireground priorities.
    - Yes, E1201 was not adequately staffed as 2/4 of the firefighters were not qualified.
    - Yes, primary searches and secondary searches were not completed on all divisions with survivable space. This was arguably complex due to the rapid development of fire up to the attic, however survivable spaces within the structure were not adequately searched. During this period C1201 announced that the structure was clear without proper confirmation by completed primary searches.
    - Yes, reestablishment of RIT was not communicated.

- **Did our training prepare us?**
    - Yes, however this structure, by definition and for size up, was an "Elevated 2-story Residential Structure". This caused confusion by 3 different companies as this structure had 3 separate divisions above the dirt. Calling this structure simply a "3 story Residential Structure" would have caused less confusion by working companies. It was clarified that Division 1 is the first floor erected on dirt regardless of whether it has living space or not.

What might we have done differently?/Lessons Learned:

- 1st Arriving BC to assume Operations to serve as a liaison to SIFD Chiefs.
- Mutual-Aid Response mimics the Auto-Aid Agreement response to ensure the safest response for our citizens and responders.
- Ensure units are specifically requested to be dispatched to ensure the closest and most appropriate units are added.
- Ensure primary and secondary search, per division, are accomplished and communicated over the radio.
- Ensure re-establishment of RIT and location is properly communicated over the radio.
- Once defensive, a water supply officer would be a helpful staffed position by a company officer.
- Companies should make every attempt to maintain discipline in their arrival/announced role to ensure completion of critical duties and minimize radio traffic during a most likely overloaded initial 10 minutes of communication.

Attachment A

Sullivan's Island Structure Fire Response Guideline
Aid Given and Aid Received

Purpose:
To Provide guidance for MPFD and IOPD personnel when giving or receiving automatic-aid from SIFD.

Scope:
This guideline applies to all Structure Fire Responses with SIFD.

Automatic-Aid Received from SIFD:
SIFD is automatically dispatched to all Structure Fires on Isle of Palms and to Structure Fires east of McCants Dr. in Mount Pleasant.

- **MPFD or IOPFD BC:** Advise SIFD to go available for district for coverage from their Island.

Automatic-Aid Given to SIFD:
(1) MPFD Engine, (1) MPFD BC, L1001, and BC1006 are automatically dispatched to Sullivan's Island for Structure Fires.

- **MPFD Initial Actions While Responding:**
    - **MPFD BC:** Add (1) Engine and (1) Aerial to the call.
- **MPFD/IOPFD Initial Actions On Scene:**
    - **First Arriving Engine:** Coordinate with the SIFD unit on scene. Initiate a water supply. Be prepared to function as the Attack Engine on scene.
    - **Second Arriving Engine:** Complete or expand upon the water supply. Ensure a back-up line is in place. Be prepared to function as RIT.
    - **First and Second Arriving Aerial:** Coordinate positioning with units on scene. Complete primary search, deploy ground ladders, assist with ventilation and overhaul, secure utilities. Be prepared to function as RIT.
    - **First Arriving BC:** Coordinate and assist with SIFD Command on scene. Complete a 360. Provide for the safety of crews working on scene. Ensure RIT is established. Request a "Working Fire Dispatch" if additional resources are needed.
    - **Second Arriving BC:** Assume the role of Accountability.